

The Wanderer

May 2026

For a while, I stared at the fuzzy black sky and wondered where I fit in among the cosmos. “Where? Or whether?” I asked myself. “Where”, I decided, to avoid killing any hope of further inquiry.

Perhaps I was a star: ever-present, twinkling with a shy splendor, but evanescent at the first sight of dawn. But the sedentary life of a star is not one I aspire for. “No,” I easily decided, “I am not a star.” Alas, my breast does not radiate the cool off-white warmth of a dying celestial, nearly eternal but ever approaching supernova. I am mortal. I am finite. I am not a star.

Or maybe I was the moon, condemned to the life of a satellite, ever-orbiting some glassy blue marble. “Nor am I the moon.” Although I may wax and wane as the stars test my patience, I think of myself as a leader, not a follower, except for the blinding principles to which I find myself gravitationally compelled to subscribe. I take in the warmth I am offered from beyond, and I cherish it in my atmosphere of sentiment. I am no moon.

“Am I a planet?” I thought about it for a moment. “Yes,” I hesitantly concluded, “I am a planet.” Like anyone else, I try my hand at the strange circle game we call life. But you will never find me in the same place twice. You can pinpoint the stars, night after night, and build a beautiful portrait of cosmic harmony, and yet there will always be something missing, like a poker deck after the first card is dealt. Something will elude you. My amber halo will speckle your canvas with malaligned streaks of rust until every thread has been tarnished by my woesome aura.

Only then will you know me, the planet – the vagabond – the wanderer.